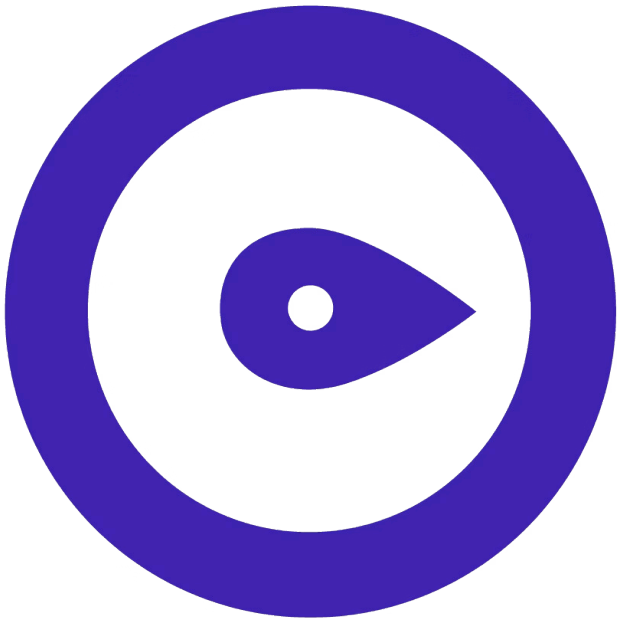
Navigate | Circle Prospecting Playbook

Aspiring to be the undisputed real estate authority in your neighborhood? Circle prospecting is your strategic advantage, transforming recent sales into a powerful source of new leads and a consistent stream of potential clients.

What to Expect: This playbook is designed to help establish you as a definitive neighborhood specialist. By focusing on properties adjacent to your recent transactions, you will be able to project unparalleled expertise in local market dynamics and property valuations, which should resonate deeply with potential sellers.

Impact: Agents using circle prospecting achieve a **20-30% higher response rate** than traditional cold calling. Conversion rates from initial outreach to qualified leads can also soar up to **15% higher**, as you connect with individuals directly tied to your success—their neighbor's recent sale. This inherent proximity builds immediate trust and familiarity.

Why Circle Prospecting Works: Circle prospecting offers a decisive competitive edge. It empowers you to invest time and resources precisely where they matter most, nurturing the most promising opportunities within your established sphere of influence to work smarter, not just harder.



What is Circle Prospecting?

Circle prospecting targets homeowners near recent sales to generate high-potential leads, establishing you as a neighborhood expert.



Define Your Radius

Contact 50-100 homeowners within a 1-3 block radius of a recent sale. Start outreach within 24-48 hours using mapping tools and property data services.



Create Value-Based Outreach

Craft messages offering immediate value and insights, such as "Did you know your neighbor's home just sold for $X?" Offer free home valuations via door-to-door, direct mail, or phone calls.



Position as Neighborhood Expert

Share specific hyper-local market data (days on market, price per sq ft, inventory levels) for the immediate area, translating data into valuable insights for homeowners.



Track Conversion Metrics

Expect 2-3 listing appointments per 100 contacts. Track key metrics (Contact Rate, Conversion Rate, Appointment Rate) using your CRM to refine strategy and optimize outreach.

Why Circle Prospecting Works

1

Be Known & Be the Expert

Regular engagement in a specific area establishes you as *the* neighborhood expert. People naturally trust and prefer recognized local authorities. Agents focusing on one area are **70% more likely to be recognized** and **50% more likely to be called** when homeowners decide to sell.

2

Local Trust & Neighbor Influence

Homeowners are highly invested in their home's value, with **85% interested in recent sales** within 1 mile. This curiosity creates natural conversation starters, moving beyond cold calls. Neighbors are often influenced by each other's sales, creating prime opportunities. Ask: "Did you know your neighbor's home just sold for $X? How do you think that affects *your* home's value?"

3

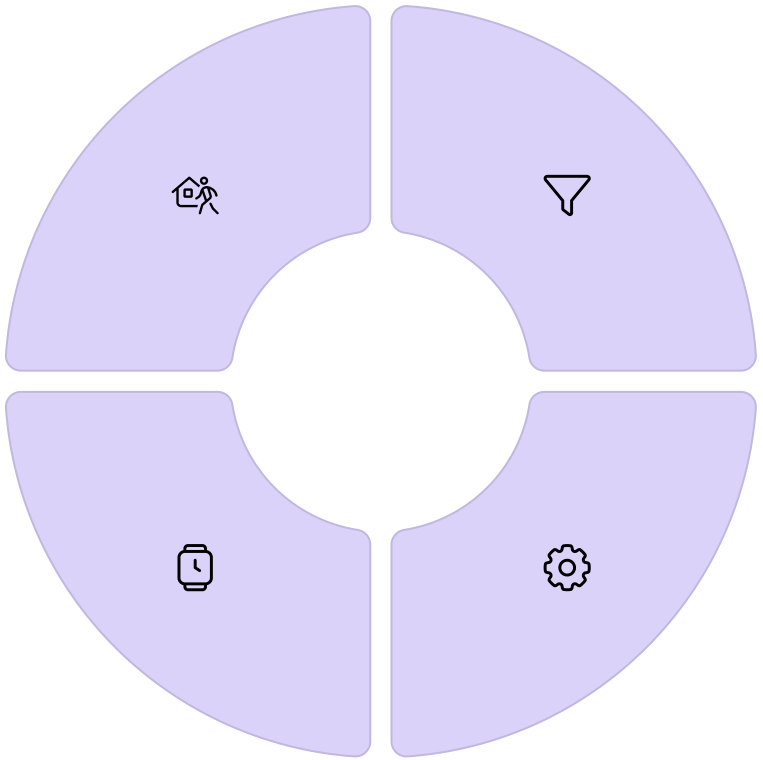
Super Relevant & Engaging

Circle prospecting's local focus makes information highly relevant; people are **3 times more engaged** with local market talk. This direct connection to their most valuable asset and community captures attention. Homeowners are **4-5 times more likely to consider selling** after a neighbor's sale, creating opportunities that lead to listings twice as often as cold calling.

Defining Your Circle

Property Selection

Target 150-200 homes around your listing or recent sale (typically a 1/4 mile radius in suburban areas, or 2-3 blocks in urban settings).



Segmentation

Filter by property type (single-family vs. condos), ownership duration (5+ years indicates higher selling potential), and absentee vs. owner-occupied status.

Strategic Timing

Launch your campaign within 48 hours of listing or selling a property, when neighborhood curiosity peaks. Plan for 3-4 weeks of consistent follow-up.

Tools

You can use a platform like Navigate to extract homeowner data including phone numbers, emails, and mailing addresses for multi-channel outreach.

Effective Outreach Channels



Phone Calls

- 5-minute calls between 5-7pm (47% higher answer rate)
- Script: "Hi neighbor, I just sold 123 Maple Street for 15% above asking - wondering if you've considered what this means for your property value?"
- Leave 30-second voicemails mentioning the specific sold property



Direct Mail

- 8.5x11" "Just Sold" postcards with professional photography
- Include 3 neighborhood-specific stats (avg. days on market, price/sq ft, sale-to-list ratio)
- QR code to customized property valuation landing page with 24% higher conversion rate



Digital

- 3-part email sequence (1: neighborhood sale alert, 2: market impact, 3: valuation offer)
- Text follow-ups 3 days after calls with link to video neighborhood market update
- Geotargeted Facebook ads to your circle with 2.5x higher engagement than general ads

Sample Scripts That Convert

Just Listed Call - Initial Outreach

"Hi [Name], this is [Agent] with [Brokerage]. I'm calling because a home just listed at [address] near you. Have you thought about selling or are you curious what your home might be worth in this market?"

- **Tip:** Sound genuinely helpful, not salesy. If they express interest, offer a no-obligation home valuation.
- **Objection (No Interest):** "I understand. Many homeowners are surprised by their current equity. Would you mind if I sent you a quick market update to keep you informed?"

Just Sold Email - Value Proposition

Subject: Great News! [Property Address] Just Sold - What This Means For Your Home Value!

"Hello [Name], exciting news! A property on [street] just sold for [price/amount above asking]. This sale significantly impacts our local market. I've prepared a personalized market snapshot showing how this sale, and recent trends, affect your home's current value. Would you be interested in receiving it?"

- **Tip:** Personalize the market snapshot with relevant data (e.g., specific neighborhood comps).
- **Follow-up:** If no response, send a brief email 3-5 days later: "Just circling back on my previous email – did you get a chance to review the market update?"

Voicemail - Curiosity Builder

"Hello [Name], this is [Agent] from [Brokerage]. I was calling because there's been some exciting activity in your neighborhood recently, particularly with the home at [Specific Address]! I have some key insights I believe you'd find valuable regarding your property. Please call me back at [Your Number] when you have a moment. Thanks!"

- **Tip:** Keep voicemails under 30 seconds. Focus on building curiosity, not delivering the entire message.
- **Timing:** Leave voicemails during non-peak call hours (e.g., mid-morning or late afternoon).

Sample Scripts That Convert



Door-Knocking - Direct & Respectful

"Hi there, my name is [Agent] with [Brokerage]. I'm not here to bother you, but I just wanted to introduce myself as your local real estate expert. A home just listed/sold on [Street Name], and I'm offering complimentary, no-obligation home value reports to neighbors interested in understanding market shifts. Would you be open to me leaving one for you, or perhaps scheduling a brief chat?"

- **Tip:** Maintain positive body language and a friendly, confident tone. Offer a valuable takeaway like a market report or flyer.
- **Objection (Not Selling):** "Completely understood. Even if you're not planning to sell now, many neighbors find it useful to stay informed. My report can help you track your equity growth."



Appointment Setting - Clear Call to Action

"Based on what we've discussed about the recent sales in your area, I believe a personalized home valuation would be highly beneficial for you. I have openings on [Day] at [Time] or [Day] at [Time]. Which works best for a quick 20-minute chat?"

- **Tip:** Offer specific times. Overcome objections by highlighting the value (e.g., "It's a quick, no-pressure chat to explore your options").
- **Confirmation:** "Great! I'll send you a calendar invite now with a brief agenda. I look forward to meeting you on [Date] at [Time]."



General Tips for Delivery

- **Tone:** Confident, empathetic, and enthusiastic. Your energy is contagious!
- **Timing:** Tailor contact times. Calls (5-7 PM often best), emails (mornings, mid-week).
- **Personalization:** Always reference specific details (their home, recent sales, local events) to show you've done your homework.
- **Active Listening:** Listen more than you speak. Understand their needs and adapt your script accordingly.
- **Practice:** Rehearse scripts until they sound natural, not robotic.

Strategic Prospecting Cadence



Week 1: Initial Contact (Days 1-3)

Make 20-30 calls using "Just Listed" script + send branded postcards highlighting property details and your recent success statistics in the neighborhood



Week 2: Value Reinforcement (Days 8-10)

Follow-up calls to non-contacts + send personalized email with CMA report showing their estimated equity position and neighborhood pricing trends



Week 3: Conversion Opportunity (Days 15-17)

Offer free professional home valuation with no-obligation consultation + connect on social media with customized invitation referencing your neighborhood expertise



Week 4+: Relationship Building (Monthly)

Add to segmented CRM workflow with monthly neighborhood market updates, quarterly value change alerts, and seasonal home maintenance tips via email and text

Setting Goals for Success

1

Weekly Calls

Goal: Make 25 targeted calls each week to homeowners within 300 feet of recent transactions.

Why it matters: Establishes your presence and uncovers potential sellers.

Metrics: Calls made, meaningful conversations, follow-up tasks.

Strategies: Dedicate specific time blocks, use a well-honed script, utilize CRM.

Tips: Practice scripts, focus on active listening, consistent effort yields results.

2

New Qualified Contacts (Monthly)

Goal: Aim to add 12 new, genuinely qualified contacts to your pipeline each month.

Why it matters: Ensures a steady stream of future business and shifts focus to nurturing leads.

Metrics: Qualified contacts added, source of contacts.

Strategies: Offer specific value (CMA, market report), engage on social media, host local events.

Tips: Define "qualified," personalize follow-up, provide value without being overly salesy.

3

Monthly Listing Appointments

Goal: Secure at least 3 listing presentations per month from your defined geographic farming area or sphere of influence.

Why it matters: Direct path to new business and achieving income targets.

Metrics: Appointments set, show-up rate, conversion rate.

Strategies: Pre-qualify prospects, send pre-listing package, develop compelling presentation.

Tips: Practice presentation, overcome objections with data, follow up promptly.

4

Geo-Farm Penetration (Quarterly)

Goal: Maintain active engagement with a geo-farm of 500 homes, aiming for an 8% response rate.

Why it matters: Builds market share, positions you as neighborhood expert, and provides predictable lead flow.

Metrics: Total homes, response rate, inquiries generated, market share.

Strategies: Multi-channel approach (mail, social, events), value-driven content, track engagement.

Tips: Be patient and consistent, tailor messaging, build community relationships.

Remember: One $400K listing pays for an entire year of circle prospecting. Follow your 4-week cadence consistently, track your conversion metrics, and adjust your scripts based on neighborhood feedback. Focus on providing value at every step, and measure your efforts to continuously optimize your strategy for sustained success.